The Tortoise Spot: Website Traffic and Search Performance Analysis

Project Question

Which pages on The Tortoise Spot receive high numbers of Google Search impressions but have low click through rates (CTR)? This analysis identifies pages for further investigation and helps develop recommendations to test.

Data and tools

I used Google Search Console data from April 21 – October 20, 2026, to examine search impressions, clicks, CTR and average position. Google Analytics 4 landing page data from September 24 – October 21, 2026, provided context on website sessions and engagement.

I used Excel to clean and organize the exports, calculate metrics, and create PivotTables and charts. The sources were analyzed separately because their reporting periods and traffic coverage differ.

Preparation and validation

I preserved the original exports and used copies for analysis. In Power Query, I removed the nine introductory rows from the GA4 CSV, promoted the column headers and assigned appropriate data types.

I filtered the working tables to examine the top landing pages and search for opportunities. I checked that device click shares totaled 100%, calculated CTR from clicks and impressions, and confirmed that the Summary figures and chart remained consistent after refreshing the workbook. For the search opportunity review, I filtered to pages with at least 10,000 impressions and excluded URLs containing # fragments.

Key findings

The “How Long Do Tortoises Live?” page received 159,832 Google Search impressions but only 80 clicks, giving a CTR of approximately 0.05%. Its substantial visibility and low clickthrough rate made it a candidate for further investigation. For the lifespan page, the query “Tortoise lifespan” generated 29,161 impressions and 12 clicks, giving a CTR of approximately 0.04%. The page appeared frequently for this query but received few clicks.
These figures do not establish why searchers rarely clicked.

Scope	Impressions	Clicks	CTR	Avg. Position
Lifespan-page overall	159,832	80	0.05%	8.57
Same page- "tortoise lifespan" query	29,161	12	0.04%	7.03

Source: Google Search Console, Web search, April 21 – October 20, 2026. The query row is part of the page results; do not add the two rows together. CTR is rounded to two decimal places.

Traffic Context

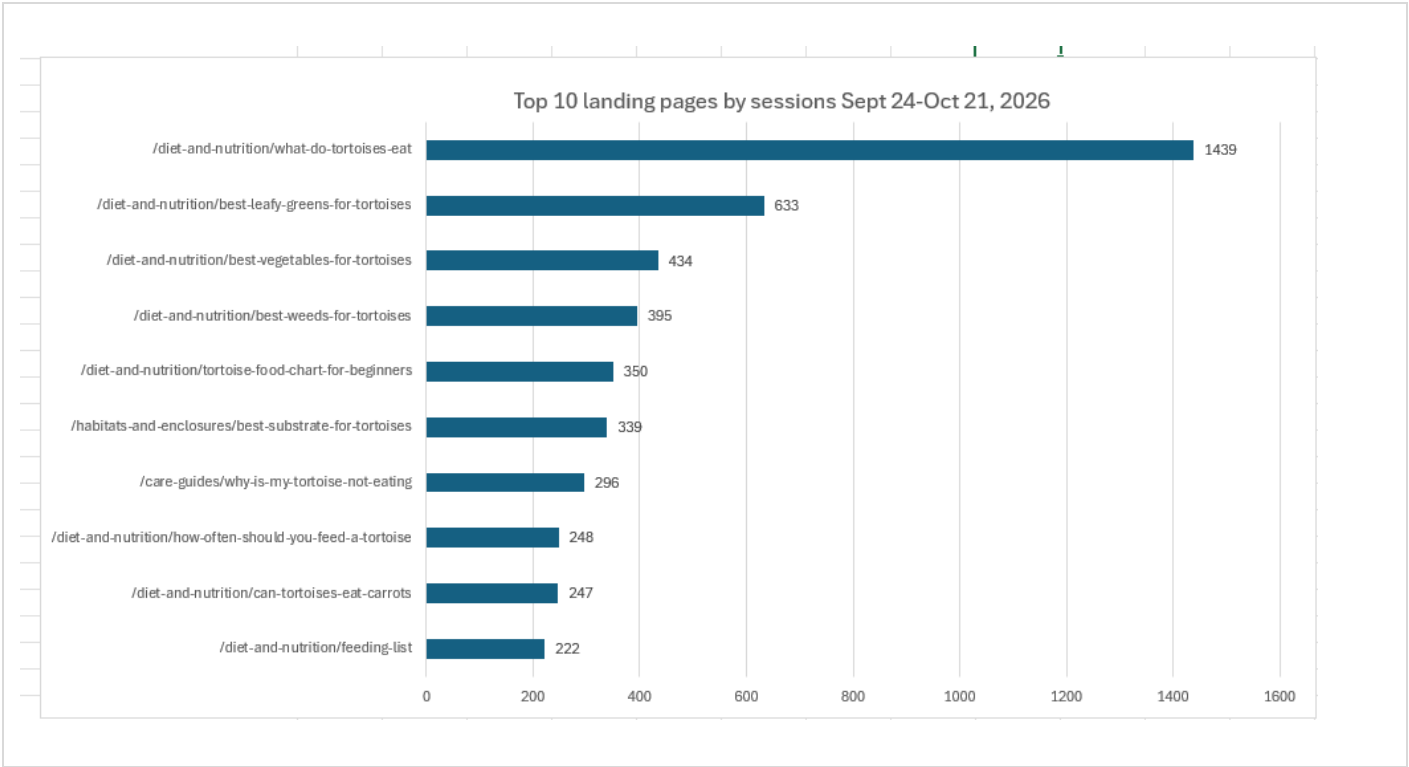


Figure 1: Top 10 identified landing pages by sessions, September 24–October 21, 2026. Together, these pages generated 4,603 sessions, representing 38.83% of all sessions. The ranking excludes "(not set)"; its sessions remain included in the overall total. Source: The Tortoise Spot GA4 landing-page export.

SQL Validation

I extended the Excel analysis using SQLite in DBeaver. SQL reproduced the lifespan-page finding of 159,832 impressions, 80 clicks and approximately 0.05% CTR. A data-quality check also identified one repeated page URL with differing metrics; both records were retained for investigation.

I checked matching coverage between GA4 landing-page paths and GSC URLs after removing the domain and trailing slashes and excluding GSC URL fragments. The query uses EXISTS to avoid repeating GA4 sessions when multiple GSC records match a page. This checks coverage within the supplied exports, rather than indexing status or equivalent traffic, because the sources cover different periods and traffic scopes.

Of 11,413 sessions with identified GA4 landing pages, 11,400 had at least one matching GSC page key, giving 99.89% matching coverage. The remaining 13 sessions had no match in the supplied GSC export.

Recommendations and test plan

I recommend verifying the article's lifespan claims against reliable sources, making the meta description consistent with the article, and placing a concise, sourced answer near the beginning. I would retain the current title because it clearly describes the topic.

Changes have been implemented on the lifespan page, but their effects have not yet been evaluated. I plan to compare the 28 complete days before implementation with the 28 complete days after it, excluding the implementation day and using the same exact-page filter and Web search type.

I will calculate CTR from total clicks and impressions, while also reviewing clicks, impressions, average position, and query and device mix. Any observed improvement would show an association rather than prove that the changes caused it.

Limitations

This analysis identifies pages for investigation but does not establish why their CTR is low. The filters narrowed the review to selected pages, and Search Console exports do not include every search query.

GA4 and Search Console cover different reporting periods and traffic sources, so their totals were not directly compared. Rankings, seasonality, search-result features, and changes in query or device mix may also affect performance.

Changes have been implemented on the lifespan page, but their effects have not yet been evaluated. Improved results are not guaranteed.